

Andy the Ant and the Fallen Crumbs

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



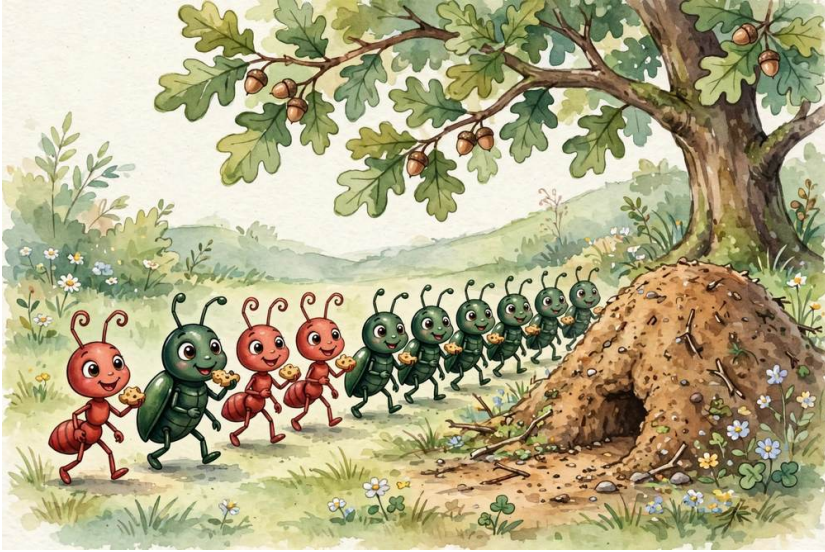
Kids Book Videos



Andy was a tiny red ant. He lived in a hill under the oak tree. Every day, Andy carried crumbs home. Big crumbs. Small crumbs. Sweet cake crumbs were the best. One afternoon, Andy found a giant cookie crumb. It was the biggest crumb ever! He lifted it onto his back. He marched toward home. Step step step. Then a gust of wind blew. Whoosh! The crumb tumbled off his back. It broke into ten tiny pieces. They scattered everywhere. Andy felt dismayed. His shoulders drooped. "My big crumb is ruined," he said. He felt sad. All that work for nothing.



His friend Bella the beetle crawled over. She saw the scattered pieces. She saw Andy's sad face. "What happened, Andy?" asked Bella. "The wind broke my crumb," said Andy. "I cannot carry ten pieces alone." Bella smiled her beetle smile. "You do not have to," she said. "Many small hands make light work." "Many small hands make light work." Andy repeated it softly. "Many small hands make light work." It became their teamwork chant. "Many small hands make light work."



Bella called her beetle brothers. Andy called his ant sisters. Soon ten friends stood in a line. Each friend picked up one piece. Lift! They marched together. Step step step. "Many small hands make light work!" they chanted. The line moved like a parade. Left, right, left, right. They reached the ant hill. They piled the pieces inside. The cookie crumb was saved! Andy felt grateful. He felt happy. His friends had turned a mishap into fun.



Can you march like an ant? Pick up an pretend crumb: lift! March in place: step step step! Now put it down gently. That evening, the ants held a crumb feast. Everyone got a piece of cookie. Crunch crunch crunch. Bella got the biggest piece. "For the best helper," said Andy. They told stories. They laughed. The moon rose over the oak tree. Andy felt warm inside. Helping friends was the sweetest crumb of all.



At bedtime, Andy curled in his cozy tunnel. Bella rested in the moss nearby. "Goodnight, crumb saver," whispered Bella. "Goodnight," yawned Andy. He dreamed of cookie crumb parades. Step step step. The earth was soft and dark. The hill hummed a quiet song. And Andy slept, snug and happy.

***Moral:** Friends can turn a spill into a celebration.*

The End